

STRESS RULES

The use of stress in a sentence may vary according to the meaning we want to convey. However, in lone words there are some rules to be observed when application of stress is concerned. Some of the rules are as follows:

1. In words with one syllable, the stress automatically falls on the syllable.

'Route 'care 'deer

2. Words with two syllables are stressed on the first syllable when they are nouns or adjectives, but are stressed on the second syllable if they are verbs.

NOUN/ADJ

VERB

'Promise

Pro'mise

'Produce

Pro'duce

'Present

Pre'sent

'Permit

Per'mit

'Reduce

Re'duce

'Object

Object

'Subject

Sub'ject

3. Verbs of two syllables ending in *-ate*, *-ize*, *-ise*, *-ct*; are stressed on the last syllable.

Nar'rate, mi'grate, cap'size, prac'tise, con'nect

4. Words starting with a weak prefix are accented on the root.

A'bout, a'bove, a'lone, a'rise, be'come, be'tween, com'prise, com'plete, de'duce, re'plete.

5. Words having prefixes with negative connotation are stressed on the prefix.

Dis'honest, 'insincere, '**disloyal**, 'illogical

6. Words ending in *-ic, -ical, -ically, -ial, -ially, -ian* are stressed on the syllable preceeding the suffix.

'Comic, 'comical, 'comically, eco'nomical, eco'nomically, 'special, 'specially, li'brarian

7. Words ending in *-ion* are stressed on the penultimate syllable.

'Nation, oc'casion, exami'nation, felici'tation

8. Words ending in *-ios*, *-eous* are stressed on the penultimate syllable.

In'jurious, 'anxious, 'gorgeous, spon'taneous

9. Words ending in *-ate*, *-ise*, *-ize*, *-fy*, *-ity*, *-cracy*, *-crat*, *-graph*, *-graphy*, *-meter*, *-logy*, are stressed on the ante-penultimate syllable i.e third from the last.

'Complicate, 'colonize, 'justify, a'bility, au'tocracy, 'democrat, 'photograph, pho'tography, di'ameter, zo'ology.

10. Words ending in *-ain, -aire, -eer, -ental, -ential, -ese, -escence, -escent, -esque, -ique, -it is, -ee, -ette, -ete, -ade* are stressed on the suffix, i.e. the syllable from which the suffix starts.

ob'tain, millio'naire, engi'neer, acci'dental, es'sential, Chi'nese, effer'vescence, effer'vescent,

gro'tesque, tech'nique, bron'chitis, pay'ee, ciga'rette, de'lete, de'grade.

Compound words

- a) In compound nouns stress is on the *first* part.

Eg 'black board, 'green house.

- b) In compound adjectives stress is on the *second* part.

Eg. Bad -'tempered, old- 'fashioned.

- c) In compound verbs stress is on the *second* part.

Eg. Under'stand, over'flow.